respect is the *feedback.* This means the government is able to assess the impact of its decisions on other actors through the feedback mechanism. This helps the government, especially those charged with the decision-making to carefully steer through the troubled waters of international relations. Therefore, the main focus of communications approach is communication and information flows and not unitary emphasis on power.

Criticisms

According to the critics of the communications approach, there is enormous difficulty in either applying a model or making use of it for a purposeful study of IR, which has been directly influenced by natural sciences. The terminology borrowed from electrical or mechanical engineering also makes it more complex in its application, and there are chances that the model can be misapplied. The most vehement criticism has been launched by scholars from the developing world who contend that the communication flow and feedback is not among equals but among unequal subsystems characterized by domination and subordination. The controls of information flow is vital as this determines who dominates the rest. Obviously, it is the dominant North which controls the communication facilities and thus the flow of information and consequentially the feedback form the weaker subsystem, the subordinate South. The proponents of communications approach have not addressed this phenomenon of dependence and dominance of North over South. Therefore, the complete landscape of international relations cannot be understood by this approach alone.